

Don't fall for it.

Fact is, millions of teenagers have worked a few shifts on a weekend—before their all-important final years—without it affecting their academic studies.

Of course, this isn't about having your teen work 50 hours a week so they can afford a wardrobe that rivals Kylie Jenner's. You obviously don't want them working so much that the only thing they can recite is what goes into a Big Mac. It's about them getting a taste of the real world.

Finally, perhaps it's not you who's dragging the chain, but your teen who doesn't want to work.

I surveyed 3500 Barefooters on my Facebook page, and 76 per cent of parents said their teens were 'keen as mustard' to get a part-time job. Yet that also means that 24 per cent need a gentle, loving kick up the backside. Here's how to do it.

Parents, repeat after me:

'I will no longer give my teenager any pocket money or handouts.'

If you don't want to raise a spoilt brat, you'll put up with the temporary drama and slamming of doors and encourage them to go out and work for their money. (Actually, it's fine to keep paying them pocket money while they apply for jobs but let them know the clock is ticking, and the money will stop in a month.)

It's really as simple—and brutal—as teaching them the difference between 'needs' and 'wants'.

Example:

Your teenage daughter 'needs' a warm jacket for winter. She may 'want' you to buy it from ASOS. However, if you're the one shelling out for it with your hard-earned, you can buy her a daggy but perfectly warm one from Kmart for \$15. It's her choice.

Similarly, your teenage son may 'want' to have credit on his phone, but all you 'need' is to be able to call him after he's finished basketball practice. If